

JUDAISM 101



Bar/Bat Mitzvah Crash Course Curriculum



by Rabbi Yossi Marrus

Chabad Center for Jewish Life & Learning

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PREFACE

By the Grace of G-d

Dear Student,

Welcome to the JUDAISM 101 Bar/Bat Mitzvah Crash Course. The purpose of this course is to help you prepare for your special day. For many young Jewish students many of these concepts are new or misunderstood. The goal is for both of us to work together through this curriculum and build Jewish knowledge and understanding.

A Bar/Bat Mitzvah literally means Son/Daughter of the Commandments. The tradition is that at the age of 13 for a young man and at age 12 for a young woman they become obligated in the observance of the commandments of the Torah. The party and festivities are secondary to the spiritual significance of this milestone in your life.

Of course, this is only the beginning. Throughout one's life it is most important to continue studying and learning about the Torah and our rich Jewish heritage.

With blessings on this very special day in your life.

MAZEL TOV!!

Rabbi Yossi Marrus, Author
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STUDY SECTIONS

- 1. Shabbat**
- 2. Jewish Holidays**
- 3. The Fast Days**
- 4. Emunah-Faith in G-d**
- 5. The T’Nach – Jewish Bible**
- 6. The Prophets & Prophetesses**
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- 8. The Ten Commandments / Two Torahs**
- 9. Life Cycles**
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SECTION 1: SHABBAT & HOLIDAYS

Vocabulary Words:

Shabbat, Mitzvah, Torah, Rabbis, Melachot, Shul, Hadlakat Nerot, Kiddush, Challah, Netilas Yadayim, Hamotzie, Havdallah, Brachah, Shamor & Zachor, Cholent, L'Chaim, Havdallah

Section 1:1 - The Shabbat - שבת

Question: What is Shabbat?

- The **Torah** tells us that G-d rested on the 7th day of creation, after he created the world in the first six days.
- The Jewish people are commanded in the **Torah** to rest on the 7th day, just like G-d did.
- The seventh day according to Judaism is **Shabbat** or Saturday. Other religions like Islam and Christianity changed this 7th day to Friday and Sunday.

Question: What does “Rest” mean?

- Don't work or engage in strenuous and creative activities.
- The building of the Mishkan-Sanctuary in the Wilderness was very important. Nonetheless, the Torah commands us not to build the Sanctuary on Shabbat. The **Rabbis** enumerated **39 Categories of Work-Melachot** that are prohibited on **Shabbat**. They are ALL based in the **Torah**. Example: Don't kindle a fire (includes; cooking, turning on electricity, driving etc.)
- Go to Synagogue or **Shul**
- Spend time with family reconnecting
- Study G-d's word-the **Torah**
- Focus on prayers and spirituality.

Question: Why is Shabbat important?

- **Shabbat** helps keep us focused on what's important.
- We need **Shabbat** to rest from the busy week.
- **Shabbat** is a time to reconnect with our Judaism and heritage.

Kiddush & Shabbat Food:

- a) Shabbat begins at Sunset as do all Jewish holidays. The Shabbat is ushered in with **Hadlakat Nerot-Candle Lighting**. Traditionally, it is the woman of the house (girls starting at age 3) that lights the candles although a man may do so as well. Once the candles are lit, Shabbat has begun in the home.
- b) The word **Kiddush** means to be holy or sanctified. The Jewish people were given the special and great **Mitzvah (commandment)** of sanctifying the **Shabbat**. We do this by reciting the **Kiddush** over a cup of wine.
- c) **Kiddush** is recited twice, once in the evening at the beginning of **Shabbat** and then again the next morning/noon after services.
- d) While a man or woman may recite the **Kiddush**, it is tradition that the man of the house recites it. If no man is present a woman may recite it as well.
- e) **Kiddush** should be recited over grape juice or wine. **Kiddush** can also be recited over **Challah**.
- f) After the **Kiddush** prayer we wash our hands prior to eating the **Challah-bread**. We wash our hands with a washing cup, washing three times on the left hand and then three times on the right. We then recite the **Brachah (Blessing) "Al Netilas Yadayim"**. We are careful not to speak between the hand washing and eating of the **Challah**.
- g) The blessing of "**Hamotzie Lechem Min Ha'aretz**" is the special blessing made over two loaves of bread on our Shabbat table. When the manna fell in the wilderness a double portion fell on Fridays in honor of Shabbat. In this manner, no one needed to go gather manna on Shabbat. The two loaves represent the two special words in the Ten Commandments "**Zachor & Shamor**" that talk about the observance of **Shabbat**.
- h) Three meals are eaten on **Shabbat**. We try to have special foods to honor the day. In Ashkenazik (Jews that came from Eastern Europe) circles some of these special foods are: Gefilte fish, chicken soup, **Cholent**, and **Challah**. In Sephardic (Middle Eastern Jews) circles Madbuchah, Jachnun, Chamin, spicy fish and other special foods are eaten. It is also common for adults to wish each other **L'Chaim** on wine or other alcoholic beverages.
- i) At the conclusion of Shabbat a special service is held marking the end of Shabbat. It is called **Havdallah-Separation**. This service is recited while holding a cup of wine or grape juice. We also make a special blessing and smell spices and look at the light of a braided candle. After the **Havdallah** we may resume regular weekday activities.

SECTION 2 – THE JEWISH HOLIDAYS – ימים טובים/חגים

Section 2:1 - The Calendar, Rosh Chodesh & Jewish Months

Vocabulary Words:

Rosh Chodesh, Levana, Kiddush Levana

- The Jewish calendar is a lunar based calendar, based on the **Levana-moon**, not a solar one. While a solar year has 365 days a lunar one has approximately 354 days
- There are 12 months of the year and on a leap year 13 months.
- All Jewish life cycle events, holidays and celebrations are based on the Jewish calendar.
- The first day of the month (and in some months the second as well) is a special day. It is called **Rosh Chodesh – the Head of the Month**.
- Beginning on the 7th day of the Month until the 15th of the month, a special prayer is recited over the moon. It is called **Kiddush Levana-Sanctification of the Moon**. This prayer is recited outside and compares the Jewish People to the Moon.

Section 2:2 - The Jewish Months

Vocabulary Words:

Hashem, Mitzvah, Biblical Calendar, Creation Calendar, Luach

- The word for Calendar in Hebrew is **Luach**. There are two calendar systems used in Judaism. One is called the **Biblical Calendar** which begins with the month of Nissan. The other is called the **Creation Calendar** which begins with the month of **Tishrei**.
- In the Torah, all events and holidays are marked with the Biblical Calendar. This calendar begins when **Hashem** gave the Jewish people the First **Mitzvah** in Egypt prior to the redemption. This **Mitzvah** was to establish a Lunar Calendar.
- The Creation Calendar marks the years from Creation of the world.
- ***The names of the Jewish months are:***
 1. Nissan – Pesach (Biblical Calendar Starts Here)
 2. Iyar – Lag B'Omer
 3. Sivan - Shavuot
 4. Tammuz – Fast 17 Tammuz
 5. Av – Fast 9th Av
 6. Elul
 7. Tishrei (Creation Calendar Starts Here) Rosh Hashanah, Yom Kippur, Sukkot, Simchat Torah
 8. Cheshvan
 9. Kislev - Chanukah

10. Tevet – Fast 10 Tevet
11. Shevat – Tu B'Shvat
12. Adar - Purim
13. Adar II (leap year only)

Section 2.3 - The Holidays / Chagim

Vocabulary Words:

Chagim, Moadim, Minhagim, Machalei Hachag

Introduction to the Chagim:

The Jewish holidays of the year are called **Chagim** or **Moadim**. Some of them mark important historical events, while some are focused on introspection. These Chagim are very different from the Secular holidays celebrated in the United States. The **Mitzvot, Minhagim-Customs** and **Ma'achalei Hachag-Special Foods** of each holiday help us celebrate it in our unique Jewish way.

1. Rosh Hashanah – Jewish New Year

Vocabulary Words:

Rosh Hashanah, Shofar, Tashlich, Tapuach B'Dvash

- **Rosh Hashanah** is the Jewish New Year, marking how many years since the creation of the world, Adam and Eve. It is the birthday of the world.
- Commandments: The main commandment or Mitzvah of **Rosh Hashanah** is to hear the sound of the **Shofar**. A **Shofar** is a horn from a Ram or Goat. 100 sounds are blown from the **Shofar** on **Rosh Hashanah**.
- It is also the day when G-d judges the world. We pray to G-d for a good year.
- Most Jews go to Synagogue on **Rosh Hashanah**
- There is a special custom of symbolically throwing our sins into a body of water. This is called **Tashlich**.
- Special Foods for Rosh **Hashanah** include; dipping an apple in honey **Tapuach B'Dvash**, and dipping the Challah bread in honey asking G-d to give us a sweet year.

2. Yom Kippur – Day of Atonement

Vocabulary Words:

Yom Kippur, Vidui, Kol Nidrei, Ne'eila

- **Yom Kippur** is the Day of Atonement (day that we pray to G-d for forgiveness).
- Commandments: The main commandment or Mitzvah of **Yom Kippur** is to pray and ask forgiveness for all our wrongdoings throughout the year. The special prayer recited is called Vidui.
- It is also the day when we may not eat, drink, wash ourselves or anoint ourselves with oils, perfumes etc.
- We also wear non-leather shoes on **Yom Kippur**
- We pray 5 prayers on **Yom Kippur**; **Kol Nidrei** (evening), Shacharit (morning service), Mussaf (additional service), Minchah (afternoon service) and **Neilah** (closing service).
- At the end of the **Ne'eila** service, we sound the **Shofar** as recite "Next Year in Jerusalem."
- Special Foods for **Yom Kippur**: NONE because we fast all day. After the end of the fast, we recite Havdallah and then break our fast.

3. Sukkot-Festival of Booths

Vocabulary Words:

Sukkot, Schach, Sukkah, Lulav, Etrog, Haddasim, Aravot, Simchah

- **Sukkot** is the Festival of Booths, celebrating how the Jews lived in temporary huts when G-d took us out of Egypt.
- Commandments:
 - 1) To dwell in a **Sukkah** –Hut (3-4 walls with a roof made from **Schach** (branches etc.)
 - 2) To shake the 4 species – **Lulav** (palm frond), **Etrog** (citrus fruit), **Hadasim** (3 myrtle branches), **Aravot** (2 willow branches). We say a blessing and shake them together, symbolizing the unity of all Jews.
 - 3) To rejoice-**Simchah** in the festival
- It is a time of great joy. The Torah calls it Zman Simchateinu-Time of our rejoicing.

4. Shmini Atzeret & Simchat Torah-Rejoicing of the Torah

Vocabulary Words:

Shmini Atzeret, Simchat Torah, Sefer Torah, Simchah, Hakkafot

- **Shmini Atzeret** is the final day of **Sukkot**. It is considered a holiday of its own.
- **Simchat Torah** is the day of Rejoicing of the Torah. On this day, we concluded the entire **Sefer Torah** scroll and begin reading it once again.
- Commandments: To rejoice with the Torah.
- On **Shmini Atzeret** and **Simchat Torah** we dance with the Torah in a special ceremony called "**Hakkafot**". The children get sweets and wave special flags.
- Special Foods for **Simchat Torah** include; sweets and adults enjoy **L'chaims**-adult beverages.

5. Chanukah-Festival of Lights

Vocabulary Words:

Chanukah, Chashmonaim, Kohanim, Maccabes, Bet Hamikdash, Kohen Gadol, Chanukiya, Menorah, Latkes, Sufganiyot, Dreidle, Chanukah Gelt

- **Chanukah** is the Festival of Lights. This holiday celebrates the victory of the **Chasmonaim- Hasmoneans** (a small group of **Kohanim**) who fought against assimilation to preserve Judaism and Torah against the Syrian-Greeks. They also battled against them in war. The Jewish soldiers were known as **Maccabes**.
- The main miracle of **Chanukah** was when the Jews won the battle and came to reclaim the **Bet Hamikdash-Temple** in Jerusalem; they wanted to kindle the Menorah. However, there was no oil with the stamp of the **Kohen Gadol-High Priest**. They finally found one flask, lit it and it burned for 8 days and nights.
- Commandments: The main commandment (rabbinic) is to light the **Menorah/Chanukiya** every evening of the eight days of Chanukah. The main reason for this Mitzvah is to publicize the miracle of Chanukah. It is called **Pirsumei Nisa**.
- It is also the day when the Temple was rededicated.
- **Chanukah** is the most celebrated Jewish holiday
- A special game played on **Chanukah** is called **Dreidle**. It is a top with four Hebrew letters on it. The origin of this game comes from the time when Torah study was outlawed. The Jewish children would study Torah and would take out their Dreidles when Greek soldiers came to inspect what they were doing.

- Special Foods for Chanukah include; **Latkes** (potato pancakes) **Suvganiyot** (donuts), because they are fried in oil.
- It is also customary to give the children money or **Chanukah Gelt**.

6. Tu B'Shevat-New Year of Trees

Vocabulary Words:

Tu B'Shvat, Ilanot, Shivat Haminim, Eretz Yisrael

- **Tu B'Shevat** is the Jewish New Year, for **Ilanot**-Trees and Vegetation. It is the day when G-d judges the trees and vegetation.
- Commandments: There are no commandments associated with this holiday.
- We mark this day by eating fruit and thanking G-d for creating trees and vegetation. We make an extra effort to eat from the **Shivat Haminim**- Seven Species of **Eretz Yisrael**.

7. Purim

Vocabulary Words:

Purim, Haman, Amalek, Achashverosh, Vashti, Esther, Nebuchadnezzar, Mordechai, Meggila, Simchah, Matanot L'Evyonim, Mlshloach Manot, Seudah, Hamentashen

- **Purim** is the holiday on which the Jews were saved from the evil plot of Haman. Haman was a descendent of the nation **Amalek** and wished to destroy the Jews. He got permission for the Persian king **Achashverosh** to destroy them by paying a large sum of money. G-d caused a great miracle and **Haman** had his downfall.
- Who's Who in the Story:
Achashverosh – Persian king, married to Queen Vashti and later Queen Esther
Vashti – 1st Queen of Achashverosh, granddaughter of King **Nebuchadnezzar** of Babylon
Esther – Jewish woman married to Achashverosh
Haman – King's minister, enemy of the Jews
Mordechai – leader of the Jewish people
- Commandments: No Biblical as this holiday is rabbinic in nature. Rabbinic commandments include; Listening to the reading of the **Meggila**-Scroll of Esther, being extra joyous on this holiday-**Simchah**, giving charity-**Matanot L'Evyonim**, and sending

gifts of food to friends and family-**Mishloach Manot**, and having a festive meal- **Seudah** in honor of the holiday.

- Special foods include **Hamentashen**, a three cornered cookie.

8. Pesach/Passover

Vocabulary Words:

Pesach, Mitzrayim, Moshe, Makot, Matzah, Chametz, Korban Pesach, Seder, Marror, Shmurah Matzah, Haggadah, Mechirat Chametz

- **Pesach** is the holiday on which G-d took us out of **Mitzrayim**-Egypt. The Jewish people were enslaved for hundreds of years to the Egyptians. Their lives were terrible, and they were harassed in many ways. G-d sent **Moshe**/Moses to take the Jews out. When Pharaoh refused, G-d sent Ten **Makot**-Plagues to afflict the Egyptians.
- After taking the Jews out, G-d split the Sea of Reeds for them, causing them to pass on dry land. The Egyptians drowned, never to be seen again.

- Commandments: The commandments are split into two categories:

Biblical Mitzvot

- To eat **Matzah**-unleavened bread, reminding us of the bread our ancestors ate
- To relate the story of the Exodus to our children
- We may not eat any bread or leaven (**Chametz**) throughout the entire holiday
- In the times of the Temple, to offer the Passover offering/**Korban Pesach**

Rabbinic Mitzvot

- To drink 4 cups of wine or grape juice at the **Seder**
- To eat the **Marror**/Bitter Herbs
- To praise and thank G-d for the miracles that he did for us

- Special Foods for Passover include; Matzah, unleavened bread made out of flour and water. It must be baked within 18 minutes, so the dough does not rise. **Shmurah Matzah** is the hand baked **Matzah**.
- The **Seder** is the special ceremonial meal on the first two nights of Pesach, where we go through the entire **Haggadah** (special book for the Seder) and observe all the commandments and customs.
- Before **Pesach** begins, we clean our homes of all **Chametz** and make sure that we don't have any **Chametz** or **Chametz** products for the entire duration of the holiday.

- **Mechirat Chametz** is when we sell all of our left over **Chametz** to the Rabbi, who in turn sells it to a non-Jew for the duration of the holiday.

8. Shavuot-Pentecost

Vocabulary Words:

Shavuot, Torah, Aseret Hadibrot,

- **Shavuot** is the holiday on which G-d gave the Jewish people the Torah. The Jews were given the commandments at Mt. Sinai, where G-d made them the “Chosen People”.
- On Shavuot we stay up all night studying Torah.
- We read the special reading of the **Aseret Hadibrot**-Ten Commandments in Synagogue.
- Traditionally, we eat dairy foods on this holiday.

SECTION 3 – THE FAST DAYS – תעניות

Section 3:1 – Introduction to Fast Days

One of the most important aspects of Judaism is Simcha-Happiness. The Torah commands us to be joyful and glad even when things are not going great. How much more so when things are as we wish them. As a general rule, the Torah commands us to eat, drink and enjoy the goodness of G-d's creations, in moderation of course. In fact, great emphasis is placed upon using the physicality of the world around for G-dliness and good things.

Nevertheless, there are certain times when refraining from the physical world are not only permitted but necessary. One example is the Fast Days in our calendar. Each one of these fast days serves an express purpose of either reminding us of a sad and difficult historical date or as in the day of Yom Kippur, a day to focus on the spiritual, not the physical.

The fast days are broken up into two categories:

A. Most Stringent Fast Days: Yom Kippur & Tisha B'Av

These fast days are a 24-hour fast day which includes refraining of drink and water. In addition, other stringencies apply to these days (see more below).

B. Less Stringent Fast Days: All other fast days

These fast days are a Sunrise to Nightfall fast day which included refraining from drink and water.

Additionally, any fast that is mentioned in the Jewish Scriptures (T'Nach) is considered more severe due to its historical and Biblical mention. They are divided as follows:

A. Mentioned in Scripture: Yom Kippur, 9th of Av, 10th of Tevet, 17th of Tammuz

B. Added Later On: Fast of Gedalya, Fast of Esther, Fast of First Born

Section 3:2 – The Fast Days

1. **Tzom Gedalya – Fast of Gedalya**

After the destruction of the First Temple in Jerusalem, King Nebuchnezzar appointed Gedalya ben Achikum to be the Jewish governor in Israel. Gedalya was to oversee the fifty thousand Jews that remained in the land, doing many blue-collar jobs. On Rosh Hashanah day, Gedalya was assassinated at his holiday meal by another Jew. Many Babylonians attending this holiday meal were also killed. Fearing the wrath of Nebuchadnezzar, many Jews fled Israel while the rest were forcibly thrown out of the land. The sages instituted the day of Gedalya's burial, the 3rd of Tishrei as a fast day.

2. **Yom Kippur**

This holiest day of the year is the Day of Atonement. This day is the most severe of all Fast Days (even more than 9th of Av). For more information, please see Yom Kippur in holiday section.

3. **Asarah Betevet – 10th of Tevet**

On this day the Babylonians surrounded and laid siege to the city of Jerusalem. This eventually resulted in the destruction of the Temple some years later.

4. **Taanit Esther**

The Jews prayed and fasted in accordance with Queen Esther's request in hope that G-d would save them from Haman. We also fast on this day to remember the fasting of the Jewish people.

5. **Taanit Bechorot – Fast of the First Born**

First born Jews fast on this day marking the day that G-d struck the firstborn of all the Egyptians (plague number 10). The custom is to go to synagogue and hear the completion of a section of Torah and participate in this festive meal.

6. **Shiva Asar B'Tammuz – 17th of Tammuz**

On this day the Roman legions broke through the wall of Jerusalem. This event culminated three weeks later with the destruction of the Second Temple.

7. **Tisha B'Av – 9th of Av**

The 9th of Av is the saddest day of the Jewish calendar. The fast begins at sunset the previous evening and goes for 25 hours. On this day, both the First and Second Temples were destroyed. Millions of Jews were killed around this era in history. Since the

destruction of the Second Temple in 69 CE, Jews have been in exile for over 2000 years. Stringencies on this day are like Yom Kippur with the exception of doing Melachah which is permitted.

SECTION 4 – EMUNAH- FAITH

Section 4:1 - The Jewish Faith and Its Beliefs – עיקרי אמונה

Question: What do Jews believe in?

- **One G-d**

We believe that there is one G-d who created the heaven and earth and everything in it.
G-d does not have any helpers or demi-gods. He alone is Hashem.

- **What is G-d?**

G-d is not human
G-d is not male or female
G-d is not part of a religion
We cannot see or touch G-d
We cannot understand G-d

We can feel G-d
We can speak to G-d
G-d does listen to us
We can try to understand G-d

- **What does G-d do?**

G-d gives people hope
G-d created and continues to create the world. His energy continues to keep the world alive.
G-d is very involved in our daily lives-Hashgachah Pratit
G-d gives us a good plan for life-the Torah
G-d can make miracles and great things.

Section 4:2: The Thirteen Principles of Faith – יג עיקרים של הרמב"ם

- Introduction
- Principle # 1 – G-d Created everything and is involved with the world.
- Principle # 2 – Oneness of Hashem-G-d.
- Principle # 3 – No Physical body etc.
- Principle # 4 – Hashem is the First and Last

- Principle # 5 – We pray only to Hashem
- Principle # 6 – Concept of Prophecy and that their words are true.
- Principle # 7 – Moshe was the greatest prophet ever
- Principle # 8 – The entire Torah was given to Moshe
- Principle # 9 - The Torah will never be changed or exchanged
- Principle # 10 – G-d knows all our thoughts and actions
- Principle # 11 – G-d rewards and punishes
- Principle # 12 – Moshiach and the Messianic era
- Principle # 13 – Resurrection of the Dead

SECTION 5: The T’Nach – Jewish Bible

Section 5:1 - The Torah - תורה

- **The Torah – The Jewish Bible**

The Jewish Bible consists of 24 books of the T’Nach. T’Nach stands for

Torah – The Five Books of Moses

Neveim – The Books of the Prophets

Ketuvim – The Scriptures

- Although the Christian religion has a “New Testament”, this is not part of the Jewish religion. Neither is the Koran, which is the book of the Muslim religion.
- For this reason, there is no “Old Testament” or “New Testament” as in the Christian religion, rather is there is only one Testament-The holy Torah.
- The word Torah has many different meanings:
 - The entire Bible (all 24 books)
 - The Five Books of Moses (the Chumash)
 - The Torah Scroll
 - The way of life and teaching for Jews.

Section 5:2 - The Neveim-Prophets - נביאים

- The Hebrew word Navi means prophet. The second section of the T’Nach is about the Jewish prophets.

The Early Prophets

- **Yehoshua**-Joshua (the leader after Moshe’s death)
- **Shoftim** – Judges
(A group of Jewish leaders spanning 300+ years. Some famous judges were; Deborah, Gideon, Yiftach, Ivtzan-Boaz, Samson)
- **Shmuel** – Samuel I & II
(Samuel the prophet, King Saul & King David, Prophets: Natan & Gad)

- **Melachim** – Kings I & II
(King David, King Solomon, Kingdoms of Judah & Yisrael. Prophets: Elijah, Elisha)

The Later Prophets

- **Yeshayahu** – Isaiah (The life and prophecies of Isaiah)
- **Yirmiyahu** – Jeremiah (The life and prophecies of Jeremiah)
- **Yechezkel** – Ezekiel (The life and prophecies of Ezekiel)
- **Trei Asar** – The Twelve Minor Prophets
Hoshea, Yoel, Amos, Ovadiah, Yona, Michah, Nachum, Chabakuk, Tzephanya, Chagai, Zechariah, Malachi

Section 5:3: The Ketuvim-Scriptures - כתובים

- The Hebrew word Ketuvim means Scriptures. The third section of the T’Nach is a number of books about the history, prophets and their writings.
- Tehilim – Psalms (written by King David)
- Mishlei – Proverbs (written by King Solomon)
- Iyov – Job (written by Moshe)
- Shir Hashirim – Song of Songs (written by King Solomon)
- Rus-Ruth (written by Samuel the Prophet)
- Kohelet-Ecclesiastes (written by King Solomon)
- Esther – Esther (written by Queen Esther & Mordechai)
- Daniel – Daniel (written by Daniel the Prophet)
- Ezra/Nechemya – (written by Men of Great of Assembly)
- Divrei Hayamim I & II – Chronicles - (written by Ezra the Scribe)

The Men of the Great Assembly closed the T’Nach. Since then, no other books were added.

SECTION 6: PROPHETS & PROPHETESSES

נביאים ונביאות

Section 6:1 - The Prophets - נביאים

- The Jewish people had 48 male prophets who were imbued with a spirit of G-d in order to lead the Jewish people. Since then, many great **Tzadikim** (Righteous individuals) have continued to lead our people.

- | | |
|--------------------------|---------------|
| 1. Avraham | 26. Amotz |
| 2. Yitzchak | 27. Eliyahu |
| 3. Yaakov | 28. Elisha |
| 4. Moshe | 29. Yona |
| 5. Aharon | 30. Yeshayahu |
| 6. Yehoshua | 31. Yoel |
| 7. Pinchas | 32. Nachum |
| 8. Elkana | 33. Chabakuk |
| 9. Eli | 34. Tzephanya |
| 10. Shmuel | 35. Uriah |
| 11. Gad | 36. Yermiyahu |
| 12. Natan | 37. Yechezkel |
| 13. David | 38. Shemaya |
| 14. Shlomo | 39. Baruch |
| 15. Ido | 40. Neriya |
| 16. Michyahu be Yimleh | 41. Serayah |
| 17. Ovadya | 42. Machsiyah |
| 18. Achiya Hashiloni | 43. Chagai |
| 19. Yehu ben Chanani | 44. Zecharyah |
| 20. Azaryahu ben Oded | 45. Malachi |
| 21. Yachziel ben Chanani | 46. Mordechai |
| 22. Eliezer ben Dodyahu | 47. Oded |
| 23. Hoshea | 48. Chanani |
| 24. Amos | |
| 25. Michah Hamorashti | |

Section 6:2 - The Prophetesses - נביאות

- The Jewish people had 7 female prophetesses who were imbued with a spirit of G-d in order to lead the Jewish people.
 1. Sarah (mother of Yitzchak and wife of Avraham)
 2. Miriam (sister of Moshe)
 3. Devorah (also a Judge)
 4. Chana (mother of Samuel, wife of Elkana)
 5. Avigayil (wife of David)
 6. Chulda (wife of Shalum)
 7. Esther (from Purim story)

SECTION 7: SYNAGOGUE FACTS – בית הכנסת

Section 7:1 - Key People:

- Rabbi, Chazan, Bal Koreh & Gabbai
- The **Rabbi-Rav** is the spiritual leader of the Congregation. His jobs include teaching Torah, performing at Life-Cycle events, counseling, and many times does the job of the Chazan and Bal Koreh.
- A **Chazan-Cantor** is the one that sings and leads the service.
- The person that reads the Torah is called the **Bal Koreh-Torah Reader**.
- The person that helps the rabbi in the Shul and calls people up to the Torah is called a **Gabbai-Helper**.

Section 7:2 - Proper Behavior in the Synagogue:

- Being that the Shul is a holy and special place, we must treat it with utmost respect and reverence. We should imagine that we are walking into G-d's house.
- Men should always wear a Yarmulka or Kippah (head covering) when in the Shul.
- We should not run or be wild in the Shul
- We should not bring in food or drink unless there is a special celebration.
- We should be dressed in an appropriate and respectful manner.

Section 7:3 - Names & Special Furniture:

- The Synagogue is called by many names; **Shul, Synagogue, Bet Kneset**, and in Reform and Conservative congregations, the Temple.
- In front of the Shul there is a special piece of furniture that holds the **Sifrei Torah-Torah Scrolls**. It is called the **Aron Hakodesh – Holy Ark**.
- Toward the front/center of the Synagogue is a large table for Torah reading. This is called the **Bimah – Platform**. When someone reads from the Torah, or is called for an Aliya, they go up to the Bimah.
- The small lectern that the **Chazan-Cantor** uses is called the **Amud**.

- There are usually velvet coverings on the Aron Hakodesh, Bimah and Amud. It may be of any color. For the High Holidays the coverings will be white.
- The Torah Scroll is also called a **Sefer Torah**.
- The crown worn on the Torah is called the **Keter Torah**.
- The Torah pointer is called the **Yad**.
- The cover over the Torah is called a **Mantel**.

Section 7:4 - Orthodox Shul Practice:

- In an Orthodox synagogue there are a number of things that are done differently than in some other congregations.
 - There is a division between the section for men and women. This is called a **Mechitzah**.
 - Only Men over the age of **Bar Mitzvah** are called to the Torah.
 - No microphone or music is used on the Shabbat or Holidays.
 - No pictures are taken on the Shabbat or Holidays. You may take pictures before the Shabbat begins.
 - No cell phone or other electronics are brought into the Synagogue on Shabbat and Holidays.

Section 7:5 - Order of the Prayers:

- The Jewish people pray three prayers daily. On Shabbat, Rosh Chodesh and Holidays there is a fourth, short prayer that is added. On Yom Kippur, the holiest day of the year, a fifth prayer is added as well.

Weekday Prayers:

- The evening prayer is called **Maariv-Arvit**.
- The morning prayer is called **Shacharit**.
- The afternoon prayer is called **Minchah**.

Shabbat & Holiday Prayers:

- The evening prayer is called **Kabbalat Shabbat & Maariv-Arvit**.
- The morning prayer is called **Shacharit**.
- Kriat Hatorah – Torah Reading
- On Shabbat, an extra prayer is added. It is called **Mussaf**.
- The afternoon prayer is called **Minchah**.

- After the Minchah prayer on Shabbat it is customary to eat a light meal called **Seudat Shlishit-Third Meal**.
- On Saturday night, after the Maariv prayer is said a special prayer is recited to mark the end of Shabbat. It is called **Havdalla**.
- On Shabbat, Rosh Chodesh and Holidays an extra prayer is added. It is called **Mussaf**.

SECTION 8: THE TEN COMMANDMENTS

עשרת הדברות

Section 8:1 - The Ten Commandments

1. I am Hashem your G-d.
2. Do not have any idols. Do not bow down or worship any images or forms.
3. Do not swear in Hashem's name in vain
4. Observe the Shabbat.
5. Honor your father and mother
6. Do not Murder
7. Do not commit adultery.
8. Do not kidnap people.
9. Do not bear false witness.
10. Do not covet (be jealous) of what your friend has.

Explanation:

1. **I am Hashem your G-d**

A Jew must believe in Hashem, our G-d took us out of Egypt and that G-d is involved in the everyday running of the world and our personal lives.

2. **Do Not Have Idols**

A Jew can't have any idols. We may only worship Hashem

Do not bow down or worship any images or forms

A Jew may not bow down or worship any images, pictures, statues or symbols. We may not even pray to the sun, moon or stars. Many other religious symbols are in fact idolatry.

3. **Do not swear in Hashem's name in vain**

We may not swear in G-d's name in vain (for no reason). This includes being careful when and how we use Hashem's name.

4. **Observe the Shabbat.**

We must keep the 7th day of the week as a holy day. We may have our family members or people that work for us, do work on this holy day.

5. **Honor your father and mother**

A Jew must both honor and respect his father and mother. This includes being nice, loving, respectful and showing proper respect and gratitude to our parents.

6. **Do not Murder**

We may not murder another person. This does not include killing in self defense.

7. **Do not commit Adultery**

This commandment means that the institution of marriage, between a man and woman is holy. We must do everything in our power to preserve it and keep it holy.

8. **Do not kidnap people**

A person may not kidnap another person, for money or not.

9. **Do not bear false witness.**

We may not give false testimony or be a party to someone else who is giving false testimony.

10. **Do not covet (be jealous) of what your friend has.**

This commandment means that we may not be jealous of another person and of what they have.

Section 8:2 - Facts About the Ten Commandments

- The Ten Commandments were engraved on two, large stone tablets.
- The Two Tablets were square not round!
- Moshe Rabbeinu (Moses) was on Mount Sinai for 40 days and 40 nights when he received the Two Tablets. Hashem taught him the entire Torah
- The Ten Commandments represent all 613 commandments of the Torah
- The Ten Commandments were given to the Jewish people on the holiday of Shavuot.

Section 8:3 - Two Torahs

There are two parts to the Torah. One without the other just doesn't work.

1. Torah Shebichtav – The Written Law

The written words of the Torah Scroll

2. Torah Shebal Peh – The Oral Torah

The instructions and oral teachings that G-d taught Moshe to accompany the Written Law. These laws were later written and became known as the Shish Sadri Mishmash.

SECTION 9: LIFE CYCLES

Introduction:

In Judaism, there are special celebrations and customs related to every step and milestone in one's life. Many of these customs are done in the Synagogue and officiated by the Rabbi.

Section 9:1 - Birth

- **A Jewish Name**

While many people use their secular names on a regular basis. Every Jew should also have a Jewish name. This Jewish name is very special and is used to call someone to the Torah or at their wedding for example. Our sages teach us that our Jewish name has a special connection to our Nehemiah-Soul. When we pray for someone's well being, we use their Jewish name.

- **Baby Naming:**

When a baby girl is born, the custom is to name the baby at the first possible opportunity. The naming is done in the Synagogue during the Torah Reading Service on the Monday, Thursday or Shabbat. The father or grandfather of the baby is called to the Torah after which the baby is named. When a baby boy is born, we wait until the Brit Milah (circumcision) to name him.

- **Brit Milah**

G-d commanded Abraham Avinu (Abraham our father), the first Jew, to circumcise himself. G-d also commanded Abraham to circumcise his son Yitzchak at the age of 8 days old. From then on, all Jews circumcise their sons at 8 days old. This is a special covenant between G-d and the Jewish people for all time. The **Brit Milah** may be done in the Synagogue, a home or even in the hospital. Usually, a festive meal is eaten after the **Brit Milah**.

The person that performs the **Brit Milah** is called a **Mohel**. He must be an observant Jew and trained in the medical field of the **Brit Milah** as well as all the Jewish laws (Halchaot) pertaining to his field.

Section 9:2 – Toddler Years

- **The Upshernish**

It is an ancient custom to give a young boy his first haircut on his third birthday. This is called the **Upshernish**. The young boy also begins to wear the Kippah and Tzitzit from this day forward.

Section 9:3 – Bnei Mitzvah

- **Bar Mitzvah**

At the age of 13, a boy becomes an adult in Jewish life. This means that he becomes obligated in all the Mitzvot of the Torah. He can also be counted in a Minyan in the Synagogue and can now be called to the Torah.

While many people throw a party and celebration, the most important part of the Bar Mitzvah is the first Aliyah to the Torah and the donning of the Tefillin, as well as the commitment to the observance of Torah and Mitzvot.

- **Bat Mitzvah**

At the age of 12 a girl becomes an adult in Jewish life. This means that she becomes obligated in all the Mitzvot of the Torah. While many people throw a party and celebration, the most important part of the Bat Mitzvah is the commitment to the observance of Torah and Mitzvot.

Section 9:4 - Marriage

The greatest joy is the joy of a Bride and Groom, our sages tell us. There are many beautiful customs associated with a Jewish wedding. For there to be a Jewish wedding, both the bride and groom must be Jewish according to Halacha (Jewish Law). The couple is married by the Rabbi under the **Chuppah**-Wedding Canopy. Seven blessings are recited over a cup of wine and then both the Bride-Kallah and Groom-Chatan drink from the cup. The cup is then broken by the groom. After the wedding a full week of celebration called **Sheva Brachot** follows.

Prior to the wedding the Bride immerses in the Mikvah- Ritual Bath in preparation for her wedding.

Section 9:5 – Death

A Jewish Funeral

Just as Judaism celebrates every aspect of life, so too, death is marked in a very special and somber way. After the passing, the deceased is washed in a special and respectful way by the **Chevra Kadisha**. The body is then garbed in simple white clothing called Tachrichim-Shrouds. This group of people then prepares the body for burial. According to the Torah, a body must be buried in the ground. Judaism does not allow cremations of any sort. A Rabbi officiates at the funeral and the mourners recite the Mourners Kaddish after the body is buried.

The Kaddish Prayer

The Kaddish is a special prayer recited by mourners. This prayer is recited both at the funeral as well as at Synagogue services throughout the year of mourning and the yearly anniversary of death called a Yahrtzeit or Azkara.

Mourning and Shivah

After the burial, the close relatives of the deceased mourn their loved one for a full week. This is usually done in the home of the deceased, and people gather three times a day to recite the prayers and the Kaddish. Throughout this week, all the mirrors in the home are covered and the mourners do not listen to any music, eat meat, drink wine, cut or shave their hair and do not wash themselves (exception is Erev Shabbat).

After the conclusion of the Shivah (7-day period), another mourning period continues for the thirty days after the burial. This is called the Shloshim. The complete mourning period finishes after the first year. Every year, on the Hebrew anniversary of the death the relatives recite Kaddish and mark this day. It is called the Yahrtzeit.

SECTION 10: The 12 Pesukim

Introduction:

Rabbi Menachem Mendel Schneerson of blessed memory, known as the Lubavitcher Rebbe, instituted 12 Pesukim (Torah Passages) that every young man or woman should study. These Pesukim represent many important aspects in Judaism.

1. תּוֹרַה צִוָּה לָנוּ מֹשֶׁה מִרְשָׁה קְהִלַּת יַעֲקֹב

TORAH TZIVAH LONU MOSHE MOROSHOH KEHILAS YAAKOV

"The Torah that Moshe commanded us is the heritage of the congregation of Yaakov." (Deuteronomy 33:4). The Torah was given to us through Moshe, G-d's most faithful servant. Every single Jew, boy or girl, inherits the torah for himself or herself. Whether they have studied Torah for years, or only know a very little bit, it is their inheritance - to learn and to keep, the very nicest present that G-d gave.

2. שְׁמַע יִשְׂרָאֵל ה' אֱלֹהֵינוּ ה' אֶחָד

SHEMA YISROEL, AD-DO-NOI ELO-HAI-NOO, AH-DO-NOI ECHOD.

"Hear O Israel, G-d is our L-rd, G-d is One." (Deuteronomy 6:4). The Shema teaches us that G-d is One, and that He is everywhere.

3. בְּכָל דּוֹר וָדוֹר חַיִּיב אָדָם לִרְאוֹת אֶת עַצְמוֹ כְּאִלּוּ הוּא יֵצֵא מִמִּצְרַיִם

B'CHOL DOR VODOR CHAYOV ODOM LEEROS ES ATZMO KI-EELOO HOO YOTZO MEE-MITZROYIM.

"In every generation one must look upon himself as if he personally had gone out of Egypt ." (Pesachim 116b). Some 3300 years ago Hashem delivered us from Egypt , from slavery to freedom. And if Hashem had not taken us out of Egypt then, we would still be slaves there now. That is why we thank G-d every day all over again for our freedom, and we promise in our heart to use our liberty in the best possible way, chosen servants of the King of kings.

4. **כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ לָהֶם חֵלֶק לְעוֹלָם הַבָּא שְׁנֵנָּאֻר וְעַמָּךְ כּוֹלֵם צְדִיקִים לְעוֹלָם יִירְשׁוּ אֶרֶץ נֶצֶךְ
מִטְעִי מַעֲשֵׂה יָדַי לְהַתְפָּאֵר**

**KOL YISROEL YEISH LOHEM CHEILEK L'OLOM HA'BOH, SHENE'EMAR
V'AMEICH KOOLUM TZADIKKIM, L'OLOM YIRSHOO ORETZ, NEITZER
MATO'AIY MA'ASEI YO-DYE L'HISPOER.**

"All Israel have a share in the World To Come, as it is stated (Isaiah 60:21): 'And Your people are tzadikkim (righteous).' They shall inherit the land forever. They are the branch of My planting, the work of My hands, in which I take pride." (Sanhedrin 90a). G-d takes special pride in each and every Jew. He created us, and He cares for us, and watches over us like a gardener who watches over a tender plant. As we grow, learning His Torah and doing the wonderful Mitzvot in it, G-d prepares for us a place in the World To Come, beside Avraham, Yitzchok, Yaakov, Moshe, King David and all the great Jewish people in our history.

5. **כִּי קָרוֹב אֵלַיךְ הַדָּבָר מֵאֵד בְּפִיךָ וּבִלְבָבְךָ לַעֲשׂוֹתוֹ**

**KEE KOROV AILECHO HADOVOR ME'OD B'FEECHO U'VIL'VOV'CHO
LA'ASOSO.**

"It is within your close reach to follow the Torah in speech, feeling and deed." (Deuteronomy. 30:14). You know, the Torah is not in Heaven! It's right here on earth, easy for us to learn and to follow.

6. **וְהִנֵּה ה' נֹצֵב עָלָיו וּמֵלֵא כָּל הָאָרֶץ כְּבוֹדוֹ וּמִבֵּיט עָלָיו וּבּוֹחֵן כְּלִיּוֹת וְלֵב אִם עוֹבְדוֹ כְּרָאִי
V'HEENEI HASHEM NEETZOV OLOV UMELO CHOL HO-ORETZ KEVODO
UMABIT OLOV UVOCHAIN KLOYOS VOLEIV IM OVDO KORO-OOY.**

"G-d stands over him, and the whole earth is full of His glory, and He searches his mind and heart (to see) if he is serving Him as is fitting." Imagine you were in the palace of a king. The rooms, the walls, the gorgeous furniture - all around, everything is splendid. Princes and rulers, dressed in gold and silver, stand about in awe, waiting to do the king's command, or even just to see him, You pass amongst them all, and suddenly find yourself...before the king! No one says a word. The king is looking right at you, watching with interest as you come near. Imagine how you would feel!

7. **בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹקִים אֶת הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֶת הָאָרֶץ**

BERAISHIS BORO ELO-HIM EIS HA-SHOMAYIM VE-EIS HO-ORETZ.

"In the beginning G-d created the heavens and the earth." (Genesis 1:1) G-d created the whole world: the heavens and everything in them; the earth and everything on the earth. This is the very first thing the Torah tells us.

8. וְשִׁנַּנְתֶּם לְבָנֵיךָ וּדְבַרְתָּ בָם בְּשִׁבְתְּךָ בְּבֵיתְךָ וּבִלְכֹתְךָ בְּדֶרֶךְ וּבְשֹׁכְבְּךָ וּבְקוּמְךָ

**VE-SHEE-NAN-TOM-LE-VO-NECHO VE-DEE-BAR-TO BOM, BE-SHIV-TECHO
BE-VAI-SE-CHO U-VE-LECH-TECHO VA-DERECH U-VE-SHOCH-BECHO U-VE-
KU-MECHO.**

"And you shall teach the Torah to your children, and you should speak about it when you are home and when you travel, before you lie down to sleep and when you wake up." (Deuteronomy. 6:7)

**9. יִגְעַתִּי וְלֹא מִצָּאתִי אֶל תְּאֲמִין לֹא יִגְעַתִּי וּמִצָּאתִי אֶל תְּאֲמִין יִגְעַתִּי וּמִצָּאתִי תְּאֲמִין
YOGATEE VELO MOTZOSEE AL TA'AMIN. LO YOGATEE U'MOTZOSEE AL
TA'AMIN. YOGATEE U'MOTZOSEE TA'AMIN.**

If someone says, "I have worked hard, and I have not been successful," don't believe him. If someone says, "I have not worked hard and I have been successful," don't believe him. If someone says, "I have worked hard, and I have been successful," believe him!!! (Megilla, 6b)

10. וְאֶהְבֶּתָּ לְרֵעֶךָ כְּמוֹךָ – רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא אוֹמֵר זֶה כָּלֵל בְּתוֹרָה

**VE-O-HAVTO LE-REI-ACHO KO-MO-CHO RA'BI AKIVO OMEIR ZEH KLOL
GODOL BA-TORAH.**

Rabbi Akiva says that, "To love your fellow as yourself," is a great basic principle of the Torah. (Leviticus 19:18, Midrash) As we work hard to make ourselves better people, we should not forget about our friends and neighbors. As Rabbi Akiva said, we should love our fellow just like ourselves.

**11. וְזֶה כָּל הָאָדָם וְתַכְלִית בְּרִיאָתוֹ וּבְרִיאַת כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת עֲלִיּוֹנִים וְתַחְתּוֹנִים לְהִיּוֹת לוֹ דִּירָה
זוֹ בְּתַחְתּוֹנִים**

**V'ZEH KOL HO-ODOM V'SACHLIS BREE-OSO U'VREE-AS KOL HO-OLOMOS
ELYONIM V'SACH-TONIM, LEE-HE-YOS LO DEERO ZO BA-TACH-TONIM.**

"The purpose of the creation of every Jew and of all the worlds is to make a dwelling place for G-d in this world." (Tanya, Chapter 33). The reason why G-d made each Jew and why He created the whole world, is so that by following Torah and Mitzvot, we can make ourselves, and our homes, and the world around us a dwelling place for G-d, where He will live, just as we live in our own homes.

12. יִשְׁמַח יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּעוֹשָׁיו פִּירוּשׁ שְׁכָל מִי שֶׁהוּא מְזַרַע יִשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ לוֹ לִשְׂמוֹחַ בְּשִׂמְחַת ה'**אֲשֶׁר שָׂשׁ וְשִׂמַּח בְּדִירְתוֹ בְּתַחְתּוֹנִים****YISMACH YISROEL BE-OSOV, PAY-ROOSH SHEKOL MEE SHE-HOO MI-ZERA****YISROEL YESH LO LISMO'ACH B'SIMCHAS HASHEM ASHER SOS****V'SOMEYACH BE-DEE-RO-SO BA-TACH-TONIM.**

"The Jews should rejoice in their Maker. Every Jew should share in G-d's joy, Who rejoices and is happy in His dwelling place in this world." (Tanya, Chapter 33) Every Jew, no matter what sort of background or learning he or she has had until now, even until a minute ago, so long as he is a Jew, he is a member of the Jewish people; and he should be happy and proud that Hashem has given him the special and greatest mission he could have -- to make himself, his home, and the world around a place where G-d is found.

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